

PART 1: INTRODUCTION

IMPORTANT: THIS BOOK HAS BEEN DESIGNED TO BE USED WITH THE DUNGEONS & DRAGONS® BASIC RULEBOOK. THE RULES PRESENTED IN THIS BOOK REQUIRE THE USE OF INFORMATION PRESENTED IN THE DUNGEONS & DRAGONS® BASIC RULEBOOK. IF YOU DO NOT OWN THE PREVIOUS VOLUME, PURCHASE IT AND READ IT THOROUGHLY BEFORE ATTEMPTING TO PLAY WITH THE RULES PRESENTED HERE.

How To Use This Book

This rulebook provides a continuation of the DUNGEONS & DRAGONS® Basic rules, allowing characters to advance to the 14th level and the DMs to expand and vary the adventures possible for characters. Much of the information given here is new (monsters, treasures, wilderness, etc.), but other areas expand on information already given. Therefore, the reader should feel familiar and comfortable with the DUNGEONS & DRAGONS® Basic rulebook, rereading part or all of it if necessary.

Next, this book should be read carefully and thoroughly, and the reader should note any new responsibilities or abilities that will affect his or her role in the game (whether it be DM or player). After reading and becoming familiar with these rules, the owner may wish to rearrange the material in the D&D® Basic and D&D® Expert rulebooks. Since both rulebooks present information under the same headings (The Adventure, Monsters, Treasure, etc.), the pages may be cut apart and then placed in a three-ring binder. The appropriate section from the D&D® Basic set may be fastened in the binder, followed by the same section for the D&D® Expert set. Hence all information for the player character, spells, monsters, treasure, and other sections may be placed together.

If the owner does not wish to remove any pages, he or she may still store both books in a three-ring binder, along with any other related papers. For convenience, certain pages may be removed from each book and placed at the front of the binder. This would be particularly useful for the Wandering Monster and Treasure tables.

When removing pages from either book, it would be best to use a modelling knife and a ruler to provide a sharp, neat tear and preventing unwanted rips or damage. It is not wise to remove pages unless a three-ring binder or other holder is available. TSR Hobbies, Inc. cannot provide replacements for pages torn from a rulebook and then lost.

The Scope of the Rules

The DUNGEONS & DRAGONS® Expert Set continues the material presented in the D&D® Basic rulebook. That booklet covered dungeon expeditions and allowed characters to progress to 3rd level. It is an introduction to the world of D&D® fantasy adventures. The D&D Expert rules cover a wider variety of more complex situations. Characters up to 14th level are now possible, and this book includes spells, magic items, monsters, and treasure not covered in the D&D Basic Set.

Adventures will take place outside the dungeon. A "wilderness" area will be an even greater challenge to players, with stronger monsters and greater wealth to be won. In expanding the campaign, the DM will create whole nations and cultures, giving the characters a history and background. Adventurers can even shape the history of their world as they become more powerful.

As player characters grow in wealth and power, they may build castles or strongholds to keep themselves and their retainers safe. They may encourage settlements around their fortresses in order to support them, eventually becoming the rulers of their own territories. From their wilderness bases, they can settle and rule larger areas, bringing civilization to the wilderness.

Through the rules of the D&D Expert Set, the campaign area can be extended to cover an entire world. This wider world is limited only by the creativity of DMs and players. It is certain that all will find yet more challenge and enjoyment to come!

Standard Terms Used in This Book

This section deals with new terms commonly used in this book. Other terms will be explained in the Glossary at the end of this book. A large part of these rules deal with adventures in the **wilderness**. A wilderness is any area that is outdoors. Wilderness areas include tangled jungles, deep oceans, snow covered mountains, vast unexplored plains, ruined cities, and even unfamiliar towns.

When player characters reach 9th level of experience, they have achieved **name level**, such as Wizard for magic-users. At name level certain classes may build a fortified base, to protect themselves and their followers. Such a base is called a **castle** when built by humans other than thieves, a **hideout** when built by thieves, and a **stronghold** when built by demi-human classes.

In D&D Expert rules, spell casters gain the options of using **reversed spells**. A spell that can be reversed is noted by an asterisk (*) next to a spell's name in **Part 3: Spells**. A reversed spell creates an effect opposite to the original. **Magical research** is the process a spell caster uses to create a magical item. Through research, it is also possible for a spell caster to create new spells that are known by no one else. Many details of magical research are left to the DM (see p. X51).

Assisting a Novice Player

If one of the players of an upcoming campaign is a beginner or a novice player, the DM may want to assist him or her by reviewing some general rules from the D&D Basic game. For example, the DM should show the beginner how to set up a character and describe character classes and levels. Reviewing the equipment and price lists helps the beginner to prepare his or her character for the adventure. Terms such as **saving throws**, **hit dice**, **hit points**, **armor class** and **spells** should be defined for the beginning player, also. The best way to assist a beginning player, however, is to get him or her into an exciting and entertaining adventure as quickly as possible.

The Wilderness Campaign

A wilderness campaign is much more challenging for the DM than a dungeon campaign. For example, the DM must have a general idea of what is in each area, for the party can go literally anywhere! Although a party can be guided to a desired area by carefully placed hints, the DM must be ready to make up minor details on the spot as needed.

In the wilderness, there will seldom be time to heal completely between encounters, and valuable equipment cannot be easily replaced. The DM will have to allow for this when running an outdoor adventure.